

Phiranga and Upadamsha

Learning Objectives

- ⇒ To understand the concept of Phiranga and Upadamsha
- ⇒ To understand the Nidana of Phiranga and Upadamsha mentioned in Ayurveda literatures
- ⇒ To frame out the probable Samprapti Ghataka based on the progression of the disease
- ⇒ To know the types of Phiranga mentioned in Ayurveda

Phiranga and Upadamsha are the diseases afflicted in the individuals after having the sexual contact with the individuals who are suffering from the disease. As these diseases are manifested in the individuals after having the sexual contact with afflicted individuals, these are categorized under diseases of *Shukravaha Srotas*. These diseases can also be categorized under *Agantuja Jvara*, *Abhishangaja Jvara* in particular. In the coming pages, we are going to analyse the diseases in a little elaborate manner.

Definition of Phiranga

फिरङ्ग सज्ञके देशे बाहुल्येनैव यत् भवेत्।

तस्मात् फिरङ्ग इत्युक्तो व्याधिव्याधिविशारदैः॥

BPM – 59/1

The disease which is predominantly seen in the country called *Phiranga (Portugal¹)*. *Phiranga* is first introduced by the people of *Phiranga Desha* (Portugal) to the people in our country. Hence, the name of this disease is *Phiranga*.

Nidana of Phiranga

गन्धरोगः फिरङ्गोऽयं जायते देहिनां धुवम्।

फिरङ्गिणोऽङ्गसंसर्गात् फिरङ्गिण्याः प्रसंगतः॥

BPM – 59/2

Phiranga is also known as *Gandharoga*. This disease is manifested by the sexual intercourse by the people

suffering from *Phiranga* with the people who are not suffering from it. This disease was first seen in *Phiranga Desha*.

Samprapti of Phiranga

व्याधिरागन्तुजो ह्येष दोषाणामत्र संक्रमः।

भवेत्तं लक्षयेत्तेषां लक्षणैर्भिषजां वरः॥

BPM – 59/3

As far as the pathogenesis of the disease is concerned, this is considered to be *Agantuja* or exogenous in origin. **Clinical features²** can be observed first and vitiation of *Dosha* is observed after some period of time.

Sankhya Samprapti of Phiranga

फिरङ्गस्त्रिविधो ज्ञेयो बाह्याभ्यन्तरस्तथा।

बहिरन्तर्भवश्चापि तेषां लिङ्गानि च बुवे॥

BPM – 59/4

Types of Phiranga: 3 types are being mentioned.

1. *Bahya Phiranga*
2. *Abhyantara Phiranga*
3. *Bahirabhyantara Phiranga*

Bahya Phiranga

तत्र बाह्य फिरङ्गः स्यात्विस्फोटसदृशोऽल्परुक्।

स्फुटितो व्रणवद् वेध्यः सुखसाध्योऽपि स स्मृतः॥

BPM – 59/5

1 Commonest sexually transmitted infections commonly observed in Portugal are syphilis, gonorrhoea and chlamydia in the proportions of 51.5%, 33.2% and 15.3% respectively.

2 Chakrapani in the context of *Jvara Nidana* chapter in *Nidana Sthana*, states *Dosha* vitiation in case of *Agantuja Jvara* occurs after a time period of 7 days. As soon as the person comes in contact with the exogenous aetiological factor, he will have symptoms related to aetiological causes of exogenous origin without the vitiation of *Dosha*.

Bahya Phiranga is presented with the eruption in the skin in the form of blisters or vesicles associated with mild pain.

When it bursts, it gives rise to ulcer formation and can be cured easily.

Abhyantara Phiranga

सन्धिष्वभ्यन्तरः स स्यादामवात इव व्यथाम्।

शोथं च जनयेदेष कष्टसाध्यो बुधैः स्मृतः॥

BPM – 59/6

Abhyantara Phiranga is presented with joint involvement. The pain and swelling resembles with the clinical features of *Amavata*. It is very difficult to cure.

Babirabhyantara Phiranga

This type of *Phiranga* is presented with the mixed features of *Bahya* and *Abhyantara Phiranga*.

Upadrava of Phiranga

कार्श्यं बलक्षयो नासाभङ्गो वह्नेश्च मन्दता।

अस्थिशोषोऽस्थिवक्रत्वं फिरङ्ग उपद्रव अमी॥

BPM – 59/7

Upadrava of Phiranga are

- *Karshya*³ (emaciation)
- *Balakshaya*⁴ (loss of strength)
- *Nasabhang*⁵ (deformity of the nose)
- *Agnimandya*⁷ (poor digestive function)
- *Asthishosha* (dryness of bones)
- *Asthi Vakra*⁸ (deformities of bone)

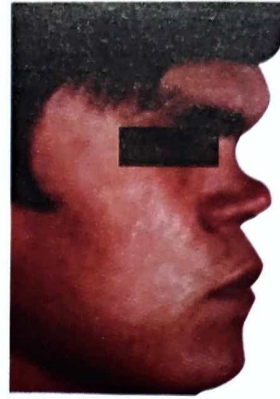


Figure 222: Upadrava of Phiranga

Sadhyasadyata of Phiranga

बहिर्भवो भवेत्साध्यो नवीनो निरुपद्रवः।

आभ्यन्तरस्तु कष्टेन साध्यः स्यादयमामयः॥

बहिरन्तर्भवो जीर्णः क्षीणस्योपद्रवैर्युतः।

व्याप्तो व्याधिरसाध्योऽयमित्याहुर्मुनयः पुरा॥

BPM – 59/8,9

- *Phiranga* which is *Bahya*⁹ (external), duration of the illness is short and not having any complications is easily curable
- *Phiranga* which is *Abhyantara*¹⁰ (internal) is curable with difficulty.
- *Phiranga* is both *Bahya* (external) and *Abhyantara* (internal), duration of illness is long or chronic in manifestation, disease seen in emaciated individuals and disease spread to other parts of the body is incurable¹¹.

- 3 When an individual is presented with chronic sexually transmitted infection or any of the infection, he may have emaciation of the body. This is attributable to increased mobilisation of accumulated fat in the adipose tissue to the circulation secondary to nutrient loss and as the person is suffering from chronic infection, whatever the food he consumes, those nutrients are being utilised from the body to combat these infection, instead of utilisation of these nutrients from the body tissues.
- 4 This is attributable to sequential loss of carbohydrate and fat from the body. There will be loss of water and electrolytes from the body along with loss of macro nutrients. Water is one of the essential component of the human body. 66% of the body contains water. Sodium and potassium ions are necessary for every activity of the cell, including muscular tissue and nervous tissue. Hence the deficiency of these ions may lead to significant and clinical evident loss of strength by the patient.
- 5 Multiple fractures including nasal bone can be observed in the patients of congenital syphilis. Bone abnormalities can be the only clinical manifestation in the patients of congenital syphilis.
- 6
- 7 This may occur as there will be shift of circulation occur because of deviation of increased circulation to the affected parts. Hence, alimentary canal will receive minimum amount of blood supply leading to poor secretion in the alimentary canal.
- 8 Bone deformities are usually the consequence of congenital syphilis. Bone afflictions in syphilis are noticed in tertiary stage of syphilis.
- 9 As the disease is related to *Bahya Rogamarga*, it is comparatively easy to cure. As per Ayurveda fundamentals, what we have to do is to bring the vitiated Dosha from *Bahya* to *Abhyantara Rogamarga* and from this *Abhyantara Rogamarga* (alimentary canal), vitiated Dosha may be eliminated either oral or anal route.
- As the duration of the illness is short, it is natural that the time taken for the complete cure from the disease will become shorter provided if the suffering individual follows proper diet and regimen.
- If an individual is having presence of *Upadrava* (complication), then such diseases are considered as difficult to cure. When an individual is not having any type of *Upadrava*, then such type of diseases are considered as *Sukhasadhyas* (easily curable) disease.
- 10 When an individual is suffering from only *Abhyantara Rogamarga* and no *Lakshana* indicating *Bahya Rogamarga* is observed in the individual, then such diseases are considered as difficult to cure, because the patient as well as clinician may need more amount of time to diagnose the disease and by that time, most of the damage might be done to the patients.
- 11 In this situation, the person will have profound nutrient loss from different angles.
- Multiple *Rogamarga* affliction which requires much vigorous treatment
- Duration of the illness is long, this indicates the person suffering from the disease require more longer line of treatment.

Introduction

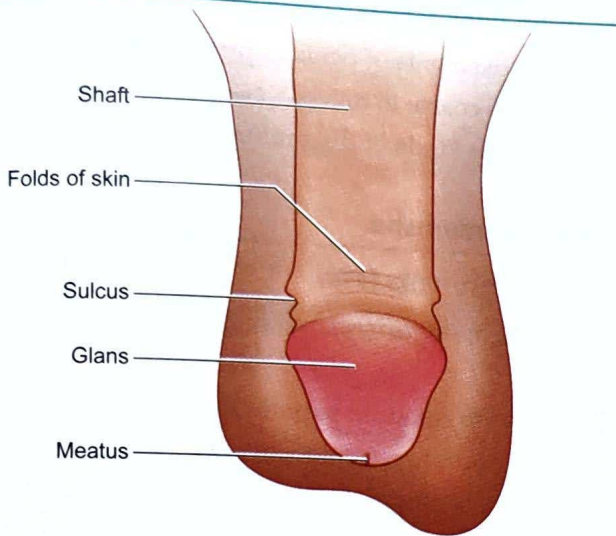


Figure 223: Lakshana of Upadamsha in males

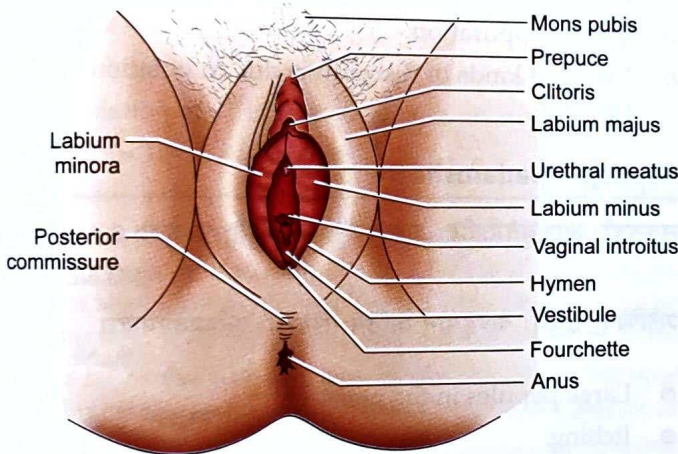


Figure 224: Lakshana of Upadamsha in females

Upadamsha^{12, 13} is the group spectrum of diseases where one will observe swelling in the penis and urethra due to external causes. such as oral stimulus or biting with teeth etc. The word Damsha refers to the activity related

to teeth. Any activity which involves teeth, tongue or oral cavity used to arouse the sexual partner and if the person is having disease causing organism in the oral cavity, that may lead to the manifestation of *Upadamsha*.

उपदंशसंज्ञा च दंशनोपाधिमन्तरेणापि रूढा बोद्धव्या।

Madhu, Ma.Ni. – 47/1

Nidana of Upadamsha

हस्ताभिघातान्नखदन्तपातादधावनादृत्य तिसेवनाद्वा !

योनिप्रदोषाच्च भवन्ति..... विविधापचारैः Ma.Ni. – 47/1

विविधापचारैरिति अशुद्धसलिलप्रक्षालनब्रह्मचारिणीगमनादिभिः।

Madhu, Ma.Ni. – 47/1

तत्रातिमैथुनादतिब्रह्मचर्याद्वा तथा ब्रह्मचारिणीं चितोत्सृष्टां रजस्वलां दीर्घरोमां कर्कशरोमां सङ्कीर्णरोमां निगूढरोमामल्पद्वारां महाद्वारामप्रियामकामाम चौक्ष्य सलिलप्रक्षालितयोनिमप्रक्षालि तयोनिं योनिरोगोपसृष्टां स्वभावतो वा दुष्टयोनिं वियोनिं वा नारीमत्यर्थमुपसेवमानस्य तथा करजदशनविपशुक निपातनान् बन्धनात् हस्ताभिघाताच्चतुष्पदी- गमनादचौक्ष्यसलिलप्रक्षालनादवपीडनाच्छुक्र- मूत्र- वेग विधारणान्मैथुनान्ते वाऽप्रक्षालनादिभिर्मैत्र मागम्य प्रकुपिताः दोषाः क्षतेऽक्षते वा श्वथुमुपा।

जनयन्ति, तमुपदंशमित्याचक्षते॥७॥

Su.Ni. – 12/7

- Over indulgence in sexual intercourse¹⁴.
- Indulging sexual intercourse in women who are observing celibacy for longer period¹⁵.
- Sexual intercourse with puerperal women.
- Indulging in sexual intercourse with menstruating woman¹⁶.
- Indulging in sexual intercourse with women who are having long, hard, thick and hidden pubic hairs¹⁷.
- Indulging in sexual intercourse having too narrow or too large vaginal opening¹⁸.
- Indulging in sexual intercourse with women who are

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- When the person is emaciated due to the illness, that indicates the person is not having enough nutrition to withstand the potency of the medicine as well as virulence of the disease causing microorganism.
- When an individual is having multiple organ involvement during the progression of the disease. Each organ affliction requires typical line of treatment and this may compromise overall functioning of the human body.
- 12 Injury can occur in any part of the external genitalia, each of which have typical presentation, e.g. injury to shaft of penis leads to erectile dysfunction. Injury to urethra leads to haematuria. Oral stimulation of the genitalia may lead to wide range of infections to the part of the genitalia if there is any ulcer (discontinuity) in the skin occurs, as oral cavity contains millions of microorganisms.
- 13 Most common areas of injury can occur in either in the vagina or vaginal introitus. Oral stimulation of genitalia can lead to the manifestation of either vaginal infection or urinary tract infection.
- 14 Excessive indulgence in sexual activity by the infected individual either male or female may lead to injury to the genital organs.
- 15 In this occasion, the lady may have injury to the private parts in a short time and if the infected individual performs sexual activity, the lady may have rapid progression of the infection.
- 16 During this occasion, the pH of the vagina may be around 3.8 to 4.2 due to the presence of lactobacillus sp. These bacteria will keep the vagina healthy by preventing overgrowth of pathogenic bacteria. During menstruation and peuperal period, the vaginal pH is moving towards alkalinity, thus intercourse by infected individual may lead to the proliferation of microorganisms in the vagina.
- 17 In this instance, the presence of pubic hairs is responsible for the proliferation of pathogenic organisms in the genital region and entry of these microbes into the urethra and vagina easily leading to urethritis and vaginitis. Thus, it may lead to the transmission of the infection to the sexual partner.
- 18 In this instance, there will be more increase of pathogenic bacteria in the genital region leading to genital infection, thus, the person indulges in sexual contact in such woman, there is a chance of spread of infection to the partner.

not liked or not sensual¹⁹.

- ⊗ Indulging in sexual intercourse with woman who has washed genitals with contaminated water or who has not washed at all²⁰.
- ⊗ Indulging in sexual intercourse with woman having *Yoniroga* (diseases of female reproductive system)
- ⊗ Indulging in sexual intercourse other than penovaginal contact such as anal or oral routes²¹.
- ⊗ Injury to the genital organs by nails, teeth, application of paste of poisonous insects, excess pressure to the private parts by hands.
- ⊗ Indulging in sexual intercourse with lower animals such as sheep, cow or goat etc.
- ⊗ Washing the penis with contaminated water²².
- ⊗ Vigorous kneading of penis²³.
- ⊗ Controlling ejaculation²⁴.
- ⊗ Not washing the external genitals soon after the sexual intercourse.

Samprapti²⁵ of Upadamsha

मैदृमागम्य प्रकुपिताः दोषाः क्षतेऽक्षते वा श्वयथुमुपजनयन्ति॥

Su.Ni. – 12/7

Vitiated *Dosha* will afflict the *Medhra* (penis) causes swelling. This may or may not be associated with wound.

Sankhya Samprapti of Upadamsha

5 types: 1. *Vataja* 2. *Pittaja* 3. *Kaphaja*

4. *Raktaja* 5. *Sannipataja*

Vataja Upadamsha

सतोदभेदैः स्फुरणैः सकृष्णैः स्फोटैर्व्यवस्येत् पवनोपदंशम्।

Ma.Ni. – 47/2

तत्र वातिके पारुष्यं त्वक् परिपुटनं स्तब्धमेद्रता परुषशोफता, विविधाश्च वातवेदनाः,

Su.Ni. – 12/9

- ⊗ Black coloured papules in the penis.
- ⊗ Pricking or tearing type of pain.
- ⊗ No movements of penis or priapism.
- ⊗ Penis is coarse to touch.
- ⊗ Different kinds of discomfort due to vitiation of *Vata Dosha*.

Pittaja Upadamsha

पीतैर्बहुक्लेदयुतैः सदाहैः पित्तेन

Ma.Ni. – 47/2

पैत्तिके ज्वरः, पक्वोदुम्बरसङ्काशस्तीव्रदाहः, क्षिप्रपाकः पित्तवेदनाश्च

Su.Ni. – 12/9

- ⊗ Yellowish coloured papules in the penis.
- ⊗ More exudation from the ulcers.
- ⊗ Burning sensation in the penis.
- ⊗ Fever.
- ⊗ Colour resembles the ripened fruit of *Udumbara*.
- ⊗ Quick suppuration.
- ⊗ Different kinds of discomfort due to vitiation of *Pitta Dosha*.

Kaphaja Upadamsha

सकण्डुरैः शोथयुतैर्महद्भिः शुक्लैर्धनैः स्रावयुतैः कफेन॥ 3॥

Ma.Ni. – 47/3

श्लैष्मिके श्वयथुः कण्डूमान् कठिनः स्निग्धः श्लेष्मवेदनाश्च

Su.Ni. – 12/9

- ⊗ Large papules in the penis.
- ⊗ Itching
- ⊗ Exudation of thick, viscous, unctuous, whitish discharge.
- ⊗ Different kinds of discomfort due to vitiation of *Kapha Dosha*

Raktaja Upadamsha

रक्तात् पिशितावभासैः॥12॥

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- 19 In this instance, the lady may have spasm of perineal muscles leading to the condition called vaginismus because of lack of libido leading to poor vaginal lubrication, thus it may lead to injury to the vagina and penetration of penis in such situation may lead to the injury to the penis too.
- 20 In this instance, the woman may have infection in the vagina and in such situation, if the male indulges in sexual act, there is a possibility of spread of infection.
- 21 Oral cavity contains millions of organisms, such as firmicutes, proteobacteria, Bacteroidetes, actinobacteria, fusobacteria, tenericutes and TM7. Anal region contains huge number of pathogenic organisms including colonic bacilli. If an infected individual indulges in either oral sex or anal sex, he is likely to transfer the infection to the partner.
- 22 In this instance, the person may have balanitis (inflammation of glans penis).
- 23 This act may damage the organ.
- 24 In this instance, the person may have presence of semen in the phallus and this may lead to the proliferation of infectious organisms in the male genital tract. Thus, the person may transfer the infection to the partner.
- 25 When an individual is performing the foreplay before indulging in sexual intercourse, the person performs several actions during the foreplay. Stimulation of partner's genitals is one of the activity which is being termed as fellatio (oral stimulation of penis) and cunnilingus (oral stimulation of vulva and vagina).
 - When the individual is biting the external genitals of the sexual partner, that is

स्फोटैः सकृष्णै रुधिरं स्रवन्तं रक्तात्मकं पित्तसमानलिङ्गम्।

Ma.Ni. – 47/2,3

रक्तजे कृष्णस्फोटप्रादुर्भावोऽत्यर्थमसृक् प्रवृत्तिः पित्तलिङ्गान्यत्यर्थं
ज्वरदाहौ शोषश्च याप्यश्चैव कदाचित्

Su.Ni. – 12/9

- Papules resemble the colour of muscles, blackish discolouration
- Exudation of blood
- Other clinical features of Pittaja Upadamsha
- This disease is manageable with difficulty, not a curable disease

Sannipataja Upadamsha

नानाविधस्त्रावरुजोपपन्नमसाध्यमाहुत्रिमलोपदंशम्।

Ma.Ni. – 47/4

सर्वजे सर्वलिङ्गदर्शनमवदरणं च शेफसः कृमिप्रादुर्भावो मरणं चेति॥

Su.Ni. – 12/9

- Appearance of symptoms of vitiation of all three Dosha
- Papules appear in penis
- Exudation of different kinds of discharges
- Various kinds of discomfort

- Penis becomes cracked, associated with Krimi and kills the person and this variety of Upadamsha is incurable.

Asadhya Lakshana of Upadamsha

विशीर्णमांसं क्रिमिभिः प्रजग्धं मुष्कावशेषं परिवर्जयेच्च॥4॥

Ma.Ni. – 47/4

प्रशीर्णमांसं कृमिभिः प्रजग्धं मुष्कावशेषं परिवर्जनीयम्।

BPM – 51/4

सञ्जातमात्रे न करोति मूढः क्रियां नरो यो विषये प्रसक्तः।

कालेन शोथक्रिमिदाहपाकैः प्रशीर्णशिशनो म्रियते स तेन॥

BPM – 51/5

- The proliferation of Krimi around the genital organs and this growth of Krimi will lead to the destruction of Mamsa of the penis leaving only scrotum. This condition should be rejected
- Swelling of the penis
- Inflammation of penis
- Burning sensation of the penis
- Suppuration of the penis
- Destruction of penis²⁶

Key summary of the chapter

- The disease which is predominantly seen in the country called Phiranga (Portugal). Phiranga is first introduced by the people of Phiranga Desha (Portugal) to the people in our country. Hence, the name of this disease is Phiranga. It is also named as Gandharoga. This disease is manifested by the sexual intercourse by the people suffering from Phiranga with the people who are not suffering from it.
- As far as the pathogenesis of the disease is concerned, this is considered to be Agantuja or exogenous in origin. Clinical features can be observed first and vitiation of Dosha is observed after some period of time.
- As far as Sankhya Samprapti of Phiranga is concerned, this is of 3 types. Bahya, Abhyantara and Bahirabhyantara. Upadrava of Phiranga are
- कार्यं बलक्षयो नासाभङ्गो बह्वेश्च मन्दता। अस्थिशोषोऽस्थिवक्रत्वं फिरङ्ग उपद्रवः अमी॥ BPM – 59/7 Karshya (emaciation), Balakshaya (loss of strength), Nasabhanga (deformity of the nose), Agnimandya (poor appetite), Asthi Shosha (dryness of bones) and Asthi Vakra (deformities of bones).
- As far as Sadhyasadyata of Phiranga is concerned, Bahya Phiranga, duration of the illness is short and not having any complications is easily curable. Abhyantara Phiranga is cured with difficulty. Whereas Bahirabhyantara type of Phiranga, duration of the illness is long or chronic in manifestation, disease seen in emaciated individuals and disease spread to other parts of the body is incurable.
- Upadamsha is the spectrum of diseases where the clinician will observe swelling in the penis and urethra or external genital organs due to external causes such as oral stimulus or biting with teeth etc. In this disease, there will be frequent injury to the external genital organs occurs which may or may not be associated with wound of the affected part.
- Due to the indulgence in excessive sexual activity or excess indulgence in oral sex, there will be vitiation of Dosha in the external genital organ leading to the swelling which may or may not be associated with wound.
- As far as Sankhya Samprapti of Upadamsha is concerned, 5 types of Upadamsha are explained. They are Vataja, Pittaja, Kaphaja, Raktaja and Sannipataja.
- The below mentioned features are considered to be indicative of Asadyata (incurability) of the disease Upadamsha. They are the proliferation of Krimi around the genital organs and this growth of Krimi will lead to the destruction of Mamsa of the penis leaving only scrotum; swelling of the penis; inflammation of the penis; burning sensation of the penis; suppuration of the penis; destruction of penis.

When these situations are associated with the patient suffering from Upadamsha, these will make the suffering person to perform sexual activity due to destruction of phallus or the person is unable to attain and maintain erection or the person may have painful erection.

MCQs

1. Gandharoga is another name of

- a. Upadamsha; b. Phiranga;
c. Shlipada; d. Romantika

Answer: (b)

2. Phiranga is the name given to the disease because of

- a. Similarity of the lesions with plant;
b. Similarity of the lesions with leaf;
c. The disease commonly seen in Phiranga place;
d. None of the above

Answer: (c)

3. Nasabhanga is considered to beof Phiranga.

- a. Nidana; b. Purvarupa;
c. Rupa; d. Upadrava

Answer: (d)

4. Which type of Phiranga has the clinical features similar to Amavata?

- a. Bahya Phiranga; b. Abhyantara Phiranga;
c. Vataja Phiranga; d. None of the above

Answer: (b)

5. Which of the following type of Phiranga is considered as Sukhasadhya in nature?

- a. Bahya Phiranga;
b. Abhyantara Phiranga;
c. Bahirabhyantara Phiranga;
d. All of the above

Answer: (a)

6. Sankhya Samprapti of Upadamsha is

- a. 3; b. 4;
c. 5; d. 7

Answer: (c)

7. Which part of the body is afflicted in the patient of Upadamsha?

- a. Oral cavity; b. Tongue;
c. Teeth; d. Genitals

Answer: (d)

8. The colour of the wound resembles the ripened fruit of Udumbara in which type of Upadamsha?

- a. Vataja; b. Pittaja;
c. Kaphaja; d. Sannipataja

Answer: (b)

9. Stabdha Medhrata is the specific feature of which of the following type of Upadamsha?

- a. Vataja; b. Pittaja;
c. Kaphaja; d. Sannipataja

Answer: (a)

10. Appearance of Krimi (worms) in the external genitals is seen in which type of Upadamsha?

- a. Vataja; b. Pittaja;
c. Kaphaja; d. Sannipataja

Answer: (d)

Chapter resources

- ✱ <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/abs/pii/S1521693412001319>
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- ✱ Bhava Prakasha, Madhyama Khanda, 59th chapter – Phiranga Rogadhikara
- ✱ www.pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/31876867/
- ✱ www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC9768959/about/bone/abnormalities
- ✱ www.caribbeanmedstudent.com
- ✱ Madhava Nidana – 47th chapter – Upadamsha Nidana
- ✱ Sushruta Nidana Sthana 12th chapter – Vriddhi Upadamsha Shlipada Nidana
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- ✱ Golwalla's medicine for students by Aspi F Golwalla and Sharukh A Golwalla, edited by Milind Y Nadkar, 25th edition, Jaypee Brothers Medical Publishers (P) Ltd, New Delhi, 2017
- ✱ The Merck Manual of Diagnosis and Therapy by Robert S Porter and Justin L Kaplan, 19th edition, Merck Sharp & Dohme Corp, New Jersey, 2011
- ✱ Chamberlain's symptoms and signs in clinical medicine by Colin Ogilvie and Christopher C Evans, 12th edition, Butterworth-Heinemann Publishers, 1997
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- ✱ Textbook of Medical physiology by Arthur C Guyton and John E Hall, 11th edition, Saunders Elsevier publications, Philadelphia, 2006
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